

D.J. PARIS

YOU DIDN'T WIN THAT LISTING. YOU BOUGHT IT.

The agent who quotes the highest number to beat the competition pays for it later, and so does the seller.

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THREE PERCENTAGE POINTS SEPARATE A FAST SALE FROM A STALE ONE.

Homes that sell in four weeks close above asking.
Homes still sitting at eighteen weeks close below it.
The gap starts at the listing appointment, not the
first showing.

THE PANDEMIC GAVE SELLERS A FREE PASS ON PRICING. THAT PASS EXPIRED.

Realtor.com tracked home sales by how long they sat before going under contract. Homes that closed around the four-week mark sold about 1.8 percent above the typical asking price. Homes still on the market at eighteen weeks closed about 1.3 percent below it, a gap of more than three percentage points between pricing it right and pricing it to win the appointment. Senior economist Joel Berner put it plainly: the pandemic gave sellers a free pass on pricing, and that pass expired. The extra month of showings, price chatter, and a stale listing photo doesn't win the seller more money. It costs them.

BEFORE YOU QUOTE A PRICE TO WIN THE APPOINTMENT:

- 1** **Bring the comps, not a number.**
Show the seller the three to five closed sales your price
- 2** **is built on, so the figure is defensible before they ever hear it.**
- 3** **Name the ceiling out loud.**
Tell the seller what the market will actually pay before they
- 4** **hear a bigger number from someone else. It's a harder conversation now and a cheaper one than**
- 5** **the fortieth day of silence.**
- 6** **Put the reduction schedule in the listing agreement.**
If a seller insists on testing high,
- 7** **write the adjustment date into the agreement on day one, so the cut is a plan instead of a**
- 8** **monthly argument.**
- 9** **Ask what the other agent's number is based on.**
If the answer is "what you wanted to
- 10** **hear," that agent priced the appointment, not the house.**

THE TAKEAWAY

THE HIGHEST NUMBER ISN'T THE OFFER. IT'S THE BAIT.

Price it to sell, not to win the meeting.

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